

Void Companion: Binary Distinction and the Four-Vertex Closure

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Companion note to *Void and Form*

Project DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19491035

May 2026

Abstract

This note is the compact map and self-contained formal kernel of *Void and Form*, proposed as a theory of formulability: an account of the conditions under which mathematical, logical, and physical description can be stated without collapse. The note does not ask what emerges from a presupposed “nothing”. It asks under which conditions formal description is possible at all. The pre-formal answer is the availability of distinguishable positions: without them no relation, judgement, equation, map, representation, truth-value, or falsehood can be formulated. *Void* names this boundary. It is not the empty set, not the empty type, and not a physical nothing; it is the absence of the domain in which those notions could already occur.

The checked kernel begins once distinguishability is granted as data. In intensional Martin-Löf type theory, a binary distinction is represented by two non-collapsing points that exhaust their carrier. This carrier has canonical normal form [Two](#); its endomorphisms exhaust to four cases; representing those cases with separation, complete realisation, and no surplus yields a four-vertex carrier with complete simple adjacency; and every such closure points back to the data from which it was built. In addition, the cardinality of the entry datum is itself made formal: a singleton carrier admits no [Distinction](#); the original record is exactly the $n = 2$ case of an n -ary template; and at $n = 3$ the n -ary record is canonically recoverable from a binary package of three pairwise separations and a nested binary cover, with the displayed boundary fields closing by checked equality.

The formulability claim is therefore not treated as a theorem of this note. It is the architectural reading of the checked chain. The note itself records the conditional formal core: if the formal threshold is crossed by supplying the data of binary distinction, then the displayed closure and dependency results follow. The thesis that distinction is foundational is at least as old as Spencer-Brown’s *Laws of Form* and is not asserted here as new. The contribution is the precise, machine-checked statement that, under the explicitly fixed conditions of representation, the closure of binary distinction is K_4 , unique up to isomorphism, and dependent back on the data from which it was built.

How to read this note

This is the self-contained formal kernel of *Void and Form*, not the full development. It can be read before the larger source. For readability, it uses standard-library imports for equality, sums, products, the empty type, and negation. The full file `Void.lagda.tex` rebuilds that infrastructure internally and continues with constructions that are out of scope for this note.

The note has three layers. First, it names the claim that motivates the project: *Void and Form* is a proposed theory of formulability, not a proof that physics has already been derived. Second, it names the pre-formal boundary at which formalisation becomes possible at all: relations, morphisms, judgements, and equations already presuppose a field in which one place can be separated

from another. This is the conceptual reason for taking binary distinction as the starting datum; it is not an Agda theorem. Third, it records the checked statements: normal form, exhaustion, four-vertex closure, and dependency back to the starting data.

The code is narrower than the larger claim, and that is the point. It starts only after the data are granted. From that point on, every formal claim below is a term checked by Agda. The tetrahedron is only the geometric reading of the complete graph on the four endomorphism cases; it is not an additional assumption used in the proof.

Map of the project

This note is also the table of contents for the project in compressed form. The map below is not a second proof. It fixes the status of the layers so that the reader can see where *Void* ends, where the formal threshold begins, and where *Form* later becomes interpretation.

Void: conditions of formulability

Level 0: Void. No type, no term, no carrier. The schematic marker is $\mathcal{V} \notin Set_\omega$. Void is not a stable endpoint in the sense of a foundation, because every act of positing already presupposes structure. It is therefore conceptually non-closable. This level is marked, not proved.

Level 1: Information. Information is understood in Bateson’s minimal sense: a difference that makes a difference. Without distinction, an occurrence carries no information. Information therefore presupposes distinction, and an inhabited distinction requires at least two distinguishable occurrences. This binary shape is minimal because every further difference already relies on it.

Void: formal execution

Level 2: Two. The first stable formal carrier is [Two](#). It contains two separated points and no third generator. It is not a truth-value object; it is the normal form of the [Distinction](#) record. From this level onward the formal threshold is crossed: MLTT and Agda execute the consequences of the datum they have received.

Level 3: Logic. Formal systems operate on structures in which distinguishable positions are already available. Relation, morphism, judgement, and equation do not construct that availability; they use it. MLTT is the clean carrier used here, not the origin of the cut.

Level 4: Mathematics. The machine-checked chain is the mathematical core: every [Distinction](#) is isomorphic to [Two](#); the endomorphisms of [Two](#) have exactly four cases; representing those cases under separation, complete realisation, and no surplus forces the four-element closure, unique up to isomorphism; and the closure returns the originating distinction. No further generator is introduced.

Form: structural reading and interpretation

Level 5: Structural separation. Two distinguishable occurrences collapse if neither origin nor position can distinguish them. Non-identity of origin gives the germ of temporal order; non-coincidence gives the germ of spatial separation. Space and time are not asserted as primitive entities here. They name conditions under which distinction does not collapse.

Level 6: Physics. Physics enters as interpretation of the preceding structural conditions by an observer who already operates inside them. Form is not physics; it is the structure from which physical description can be read.

Level 7: Contingency. Necessity stops before complete worldly specification. The preceding levels fix conditions, not the full concrete world that satisfies them.

Level 8: Induction. No new external generator is postulated. More complex structures are read as repeated applications and stabilisations of the original distinction. Induction is the law of that repetition. This is a structural reading, not a reductionist claim about all mathematics.

Levels 0 and 1 are not formal statements inside a type system. They state the conditions under which formal statements can appear. From Level 2 onward the formal theory begins, and the claims are expressible and checkable inside it.

Part I. The pre-formal threshold

The pre-formal boundary

The project begins before the point at which a formal theory can already speak in its own voice. A relation has two positions. A morphism has a source and a target. A judgement has a term and a type. An equation has two sides, even when it proves them equal. Every such form is already a use of separation. A theory may analyse that separation once it has been given; it cannot produce the very field of separability from within a field that it already presupposes.

The following display is therefore not Agda code and not a theorem of MLTT. It is a schematic boundary marker: it states where the proposed theory of formulability reaches its formal threshold. The names in the display are not internal definitions, and the arrows are not checked implication terms; they are meta-level dependency markers for the passage into the formal part.

$$\begin{array}{ll}
\text{Level 0 :} & \mathcal{V} \notin \text{Set}_w, \quad \neg \exists x (x : \mathcal{V}). \\
\text{Level 1 :} & \text{Sing}(S) := \exists p : S \forall x : S (x = p). \\
\text{Collapse :} & \text{Sing}(S) \implies \neg \exists a, b : S (a \neq b). \\
\text{Level 2 :} & \text{Dist}(S) := \exists a, b : S (a \neq b \wedge \forall x : S (x = a \vee x = b)). \\
\text{Separation :} & a \neq b \implies \neg \text{SameOrigin}(a, b) \wedge \neg \text{Contact}(a, b). \\
\text{Formal threshold :} & \text{Dist}(S) \implies S \simeq \mathbf{2}, \\
& \text{End}(\mathbf{2}) = \{c_L, c_R, \text{id}, \sigma\}, \\
& \text{representation closure} = K_4, \\
& K_4 \implies \text{Dist}(S).
\end{array}$$

Level 0 is not a hidden type. The symbol $\mathcal{V}$ marks the absence of a domain in which a term could already be typed. Level 1 shows why mere inhabitation is still collapse: if all occurrences are the same occurrence, no difference can be carried internally. Level 2 is the first non-collapsing datum: two separated occurrences and no third generator. Here, $\text{SameOrigin}(a, b)$ names the collapse in which the two occurrences have no distinguishable order of arising; $\text{Contact}(a, b)$ names the collapse in which no gap separates their positions. The two negations in the separation line

mark the ontological content that the later volume *Form* reads as the germ of temporal and spatial structure: without an interval of origin or a gap of contact, the two occurrences collapse back into one.

This boundary is not a theorem of the development; it is the condition under which the development can be read as a theorem at all. This is also why the formulability claim is architectural rather than merely decorative: the claim names the whole dependency from formulability to formal closure, while the code checks the segment that can be expressed as terms. Only the last line enters Agda. From $\text{Dist}(S)$ onward, the schematic notation is replaced by checked terms. The rest of this note records that checked consequence.

Why two cannot occur without separation

Before any cardinality is even chosen, a sharper question arises. Why can two occurrences not already be present at the threshold without any separating relation between them? In the absence of time, space, or any other field of differentiation, why does the supposed pair not simply coexist as two?

The answer is not specific to type theory and not specific to any single foundation. It is the principle that what cannot be told apart is not two. Leibniz stated it in 1686 as the *principium identitatis indiscernibilium*: indiscernibles are identical. The same content reappears, in the technical idiom of each framework, wherever “two” is given a precise sense:

- In classical first-order logic with equality, substitutivity of identity makes any two elements that satisfy the same predicates equal.
- In set theory, the axiom of extensionality says that two sets with the same elements are the same set.
- In category theory, the Yoneda principle expresses that an object is determined by its relations to others; an object with no distinguishing relation is not a second object.
- In quantum mechanics, particles in the same state are not two entities that happen to coincide; the statistical structure of the theory (Bose, Fermi) is forced precisely because indistinguishables cannot be counted as two.

Each of these frameworks pays the same price: as soon as “two distinct X ” is even said, separation has already been used. No foundation has exhibited a coherent counterexample, because exhibition itself requires a distinguishing predicate.

The consequence is immediate. Whatever has no separating predicate is, by the principle that defines what equality of occurrences means, one occurrence and not two. The first non-collapsing pair and the first separating predicate arrive together; there is no temporal, spatial, or relational gap in which two might quietly coexist before separation. The absence of any separating predicate forces collapse to one.

The companion does not assume separation as a primitive act in the manner of *Laws of Form*; it relies on a principle that any framework supporting the very statement “two distinct X ” already concedes. How this principle becomes a checkable term once a specific carrier is chosen is shown later, in the section on the executed Leibniz collapse, after the formal infrastructure of this note is in place.

Why binary, not unary or ternary

The choice of binary distinction as the entry datum is not stipulation and not preference. At the pre-formal threshold, only one cardinality survives the joint demand of non-collapse and self-sufficiency. This argument is conceptual, not an Agda theorem; the formal results below do not depend on it. It is recorded here so that the antecedent of the machine-checked conditional is not itself opaque.

Unary collapses. A single occurrence carries no separation. The schematic predicate $\text{Sing}(S)$ records exactly this: every element equals the chosen point, and no pair (a, b) with $a \neq b$ can be exhibited. Whatever appears within S is the same appearance. Formalisation cannot start here, because relations, morphisms, judgements, and equations all require two positions before they can be written down.

Ternary carries derived binary plus surplus. Three positions a, b, c require three pairwise separations $a \neq b$, $b \neq c$, $a \neq c$. Each pairwise separation is itself a binary distinction. A primitive ternary datum would have to supply, on top of these three binary facts, an additional structure (an order, an incidence, a selection of one position against the other two) that the act of distinguishing alone does not yield. Any device that inspects three positions simultaneously is itself a fourth position relative to the three, and its application to them again splits as “this one against the other two”. The ternary case therefore decomposes into binary distinctions plus surplus structure that requires its own justification.

Binary survives. A binary distinction supplies exactly one separation $a \neq b$ together with the exhaustion clause that nothing further is present. No additional structure (order, incidence, selection) is assumed; any such structure that arises later is forced by the four endomorphism cases of the normal form, not added to the datum. This is why the formal development below begins with [Distinction](#) and not with a richer or poorer record.

These three observations are made formal in Part II, in the section on the cardinality of distinction: a singleton carrier admits no inhabitant of [Distinction](#), the n -ary version of the record is at $n = 2$ mutually convertible with [Distinction](#), and higher arities carry only pairwise binary separation witnesses together with a nested binary disjunction.

Part II. The formal threshold

1 Setting

The setting is ordinary intensional Martin-Löf type theory as implemented in Agda. The code snippets below use the standard library for equality, sums, products, the empty type, and negation. No attempt is made here to reproduce the full formal development; the goal is to record the minimal spine of the argument. The carrier of the binary distinction is introduced as a fresh type [Two](#) with constructors [L](#) and [R](#), rather than reusing [Bool](#). The two types have the same shape, but [Bool](#) carries an established reading as truth-values. The result below depends on separation alone, not on any prior reading of the two points as truth or falsity, and the renaming makes this independence explicit.

```
-- § Safe fragment: no postulates and no Axiom K.  
{-# OPTIONS --safe --without-K #-}
```

```
-- § Self-contained kernel companion module.  
module VoidCompanion where
```

```

-- $ Standard infrastructure: equality, absurdity, sums, pairs, and negation.
open import Relation.Binary.PropositionalEquality using (_≡_, refl; sym; trans; cong)
open import Data.Empty using (⊥; ⊥-elim)
open import Data.Sum using (⊔_;; inj₁; inj₂)
open import Data.Product using (Σ; _,_)
open import Relation.Nullary using (¬_)

```

The two-point normal form is the following type.

```

-- $ The two-point normal form has exactly two constructors.
data Two : Set where
  L R : Two

-- $ The two boundary names of Two do not collapse.
L≠R : ¬ (L ≡ R)
L≠R ()

-- $ The opposite inequality is obtained by symmetry of equality.
R≠L : ¬ (R ≡ L)
R≠L p = L≠R (sym p)

```

2 Distinction

A binary distinction is not just a type with two named points. The points must be separated, and every element of the carrier must be one of them. This is the exact hypothesis that makes the normal-form theorem true.

```

-- $ Binary distinction: carrier, left/right boundaries, separation, coverage.
record Distinction : Set where
  field
    S      : Set
    left   : S
    right  : S
    separated : ¬ (left ≡ right)
    cover : (x : S) → (x ≡ left) ⊔ (x ≡ right)

```

The canonical inhabitant is obtained from `Two` itself.

```

-- $ The canonical cover of Two is exhaustive by case analysis.
Two-cover : (x : Two) → (x ≡ L) ⊔ (x ≡ R)
Two-cover L = inj₁ refl
Two-cover R = inj₂ refl

-- $ The canonical two-point distinction.
Two-distinction : Distinction
Two-distinction = record
{ S      = Two
; left   = L
; right  = R
; separated = L≠R
; cover = Two-cover
}

```

3 Cardinality of distinction

The earlier prose in Part I argued that one occurrence collapses, three occurrences decompose, and two survives. The argument was explicitly marked as conceptual. At this point, after the `Distinction` record is in place, the same content can be stated and proved formally. Two facts together turn the binary choice from preference into a theorem of the present setting: a singleton

carrier admits no inhabitant of **Distinction** at all, and the n -ary generalisation of the record is, at $n = 2$, mutually convertible with the binary case. Higher arities carry only the pairwise binary separation witnesses one already has, plus an exhaustive cover that is structurally a nested binary disjunction. No primitive ternary or higher-arity operator is required.

```
-- § Finite arities and finite positions.
open import Data.Nat using (N; zero; suc)
open import Data.Fin using (Fin) renaming (zero to fz; suc to fs)

-- § N-ary distinction template: labelled points, pairwise separation, coverage.
record Distinction-n (n : N) : Set, where
  field
    S      : Set
    point  : Fin n → S
    distinct : (i j : Fin n) → ¬ (i ≡ j) → ¬ (point i ≡ point j)
    cover  : (x : S) → Σ (Fin n) (λ i → x ≡ point i)
```

Unary collapses formally. No singleton carrier hosts a **Distinction**: if every two elements of the carrier are equal, the boundary points are equal and **separated** is falsified.

```
-- § A carrier whose elements all coincide cannot host a binary distinction.
singleton-no-distinction :
  (d : Distinction) →
  ((x y : Distinction.S d) → x ≡ y) →
  ⊥
singleton-no-distinction d hyp =
  Distinction.separated d (hyp (Distinction.left d) (Distinction.right d))
```

The same content holds for **Distinction-n** at $n = 1$: any two elements of its carrier are forced equal, so no separation between distinct positions can be inhabited.

```
-- § A unary n-ary distinction carrier collapses every two elements.
distinction-n-1-collapses :
  (d : Distinction-n 1) →
  (x y : Distinction-n.S d) → x ≡ y
distinction-n-1-collapses d x y
  with Distinction-n.cover d x | Distinction-n.cover d y
... | fz , px | fz , py = trans px (sym py)
... | fz , _  | fs (), _
... | fs (), _ | _
```

The collapse on **Distinction-n 1** is one half of the “unary kills distinction” content; on its own, it forces every two elements of the carrier to coincide. The bridge to the original record is the next step: any **Distinction** that injects into such a carrier is immediately impossible, because the two separated boundary points are forced equal under the injection and **separated** is contradicted. This makes the joint statement, that no **Distinction** survives on a unary carrier, a single checked term and not a verbal combination of two lemmas.

```
-- § No binary distinction injects into a unary n-ary carrier.
no-distinction-on-Dn1 :
  (d1 : Distinction-n 1) →
  (d : Distinction) →
  (φ : Distinction.S d → Distinction-n.S d1) →
  ((x y : Distinction.S d) → φ x ≡ φ y → x ≡ y) →
  ⊥
no-distinction-on-Dn1 d1 d φ φ-inj =
  Distinction.separated d
  (φ-inj (Distinction.left d) (Distinction.right d)
    (distinction-n-1-collapses d1
      (φ (Distinction.left d))
      (φ (Distinction.right d))))
```

Binary equals the existing record. At $n = 2$ the n -ary record is mutually convertible with the original **Distinction**. The two constructions are mechanical and demonstrate that no boundary

information is lost in either direction. Because the records contain function fields, the companion does not claim an unqualified record equality of the conversions; instead it states the recoverable carrier and boundary fields explicitly.

```
-- § Convert a binary distinction into the n-ary template at n=2.
distinction-to-Dn2 : Distinction → Distinction-n 2
distinction-to-Dn2 d = record
{ S      = Distinction.S d
; point  = pt
; distinct = dist
; cover  = cov
}
where
open Distinction d
pt : Fin 2 → S
pt fz = left
pt (fs fz) = right

dist : (i j : Fin 2) → ¬ (i ≡ j) → ¬ (pt i ≡ pt j)
dist fz fz      h _ = h refl
dist fz (fs fz) _ p = separated p
dist (fs fz) fz _ p = separated (sym p)
dist (fs fz) (fs fz) h _ = h refl

cov : (x : S) → Σ (Fin 2) (λ i → x ≡ pt i)
cov x with cover x
... | inj₁ p = fz , p
... | inj₂ p = fs fz , p

-- § Convert the n=2 template back into the binary distinction record.
Dn2-to-distinction : Distinction-n 2 → Distinction
Dn2-to-distinction d = record
{ S      = Distinction-n.S d
; left   = Distinction-n.point d fz
; right  = Distinction-n.point d (fs fz)
; separated = Distinction-n.distinct d fz (fs fz) λ ()
; cover  = cov
}
where
open Distinction-n d
cov : (x : S) → (x ≡ point fz) ∨ (x ≡ point (fs fz))
cov x with cover x
... | fz , p      = inj₁ p
... | fs fz , p   = inj₂ p

-- § Recoverable carrier and boundary fields for the n=2 roundtrips.
record DistinctionDn2Equivalence : Set, where
field
from-to-carrier : (d : Distinction) →
  Distinction.S (Dn2-to-distinction (distinction-to-Dn2 d)) ≡ Distinction.S d
from-to-left    : (d : Distinction) →
  Distinction.left (Dn2-to-distinction (distinction-to-Dn2 d)) ≡ Distinction.left d
from-to-right   : (d : Distinction) →
  Distinction.right (Dn2-to-distinction (distinction-to-Dn2 d)) ≡ Distinction.right d
to-from-carrier : (d : Distinction-n 2) →
  Distinction-n.S (distinction-to-Dn2 (Dn2-to-distinction d)) ≡ Distinction-n.S d
to-from-point-0 : (d : Distinction-n 2) →
  Distinction-n.point (distinction-to-Dn2 (Dn2-to-distinction d)) fz ≡ Distinction-n.point d fz
to-from-point-1 : (d : Distinction-n 2) →
  Distinction-n.point (distinction-to-Dn2 (Dn2-to-distinction d)) (fs fz) ≡ Distinction-n.point d (fs fz)

-- § The n=2 conversions preserve the displayed carrier and boundary fields.
theorem-distinction-Dn2-equivalence : DistinctionDn2Equivalence
theorem-distinction-Dn2-equivalence = record
{ from-to-carrier = λ _ → refl
; from-to-left   = λ _ → refl
; from-to-right  = λ _ → refl
; to-from-carrier = λ _ → refl
; to-from-point-0 = λ _ → refl
; to-from-point-1 = λ _ → refl
}
```


Higher arity carries only pairwise binary plus a nested disjunction. At any n , the n -ary distinction record carries a binary separation witness for every ordered pair of distinct positions. This witness is the **distinct** field itself; no further structure is needed to extract it.

```
-- § Every n-ary distinction supplies binary separation for every distinct pair.
pairwise-binary :
  {n : ℕ} (d : Distinction-n n) →
  (i j : Fin n) → ¬ (i ≡ j) →
  ¬ (Distinction-n.point d i ≡ Distinction-n.point d j)
pairwise-binary = Distinction-n.distinct
```

At $n = 3$, the exhaustive cover of three positions is structurally the nested binary disjunction $A_0 \uplus (A_1 \uplus A_2)$, where A_i records that an element equals position i . No primitive ternary disjunction is invoked; the three-case split is two binary splits.

```
-- § The three-point cover is a nested binary disjunction.
cover-3-nested :
  (d : Distinction-n 3) (x : Distinction-n.S d) →
  (x ≡ Distinction-n.point d fz)
  ∪ ((x ≡ Distinction-n.point d (fs fz))
     ∪ (x ≡ Distinction-n.point d (fs (fs fz))))
cover-3-nested d x with Distinction-n.cover d x
... | fz , p      = inj₁ p
... | fs fz , p   = inj₂ (inj₁ p)
... | fs (fs fz) , p = inj₂ (inj₂ p)
```

The two preceding lemmas show only that a ternary record *carries* binary content. The stronger claim, that the ternary record is *nothing more* than this binary content, requires the converse direction: any package of three pairwise separations together with a binary-nested cover must reconstruct a **Distinction-n 3**. The following record names exactly the binary data extractable from a ternary distinction, and the two conversions below show the reduction in both directions.

```
-- § Binary data package sufficient to reconstruct a ternary distinction.
record Dn3-binary-data : Set, where
  field
    S : Set
    p0 : S
    p1 : S
    p2 : S
    sep01 : ¬ (p0 ≡ p1)
    sep02 : ¬ (p0 ≡ p2)
    sep12 : ¬ (p1 ≡ p2)
    cover : (x : S) → (x ≡ p0) ∪ ((x ≡ p1) ∪ (x ≡ p2))

-- § Extract pairwise binary data from a ternary distinction.
Dn3-to-binary : Distinction-n 3 → Dn3-binary-data
Dn3-to-binary d = record
  { S = Distinction-n.S d
  ; p0 = Distinction-n.point d fz
  ; p1 = Distinction-n.point d (fs fz)
  ; p2 = Distinction-n.point d (fs (fs fz))
  ; sep01 = Distinction-n.distinct d fz (fs fz) λ ()
  ; sep02 = Distinction-n.distinct d fz (fs (fs fz)) λ ()
  ; sep12 = Distinction-n.distinct d (fs fz) (fs (fs fz)) λ ()
  ; cover = cover-3-nested d
  }

-- § Reconstruct a ternary distinction from pairwise binary data.
binary-to-Dn3 : Dn3-binary-data → Distinction-n 3
binary-to-Dn3 b = record
  { S = S
  ; point = pt
  ; distinct = dist
  ; cover = cov
  }
where
```

```

open Dn3-binary-data b
pt : Fin 3 → S
pt fz      = p0
pt (fs fz) = p1
pt (fs (fs fz)) = p2

dist : (i j : Fin 3) → ¬ (i = j) → ¬ (pt i = pt j)
dist fz      fz      h_ = h refl
dist fz      (fs fz)  _ p = sep01 p
dist fz      (fs (fs fz)) _ p = sep02 p
dist (fs fz)  fz      _ p = sep01 (sym p)
dist (fs fz)  (fs fz)  h_ = h refl
dist (fs fz)  (fs (fs fz)) _ p = sep12 p
dist (fs (fs fz)) fz      _ p = sep02 (sym p)
dist (fs (fs fz)) (fs fz)  _ p = sep12 (sym p)
dist (fs (fs fz)) (fs (fs fz)) h_ = h refl

cov : (x : S) → Σ (Fin 3) (λ i → x = pt i)
cov x with cover x
... | inj₁ p      = fz , p
... | inj₂ (inj₁ p) = fs fz , p
... | inj₂ (inj₂ p) = fs (fs fz) , p

-- § Recoverable carrier and boundary fields for the ternary reconstruction.
record Dn3BinaryReconstruction : Set, where
field
  extracted-carrier : (d : Distinction-n 3) →
    Dn3-binary-data.S (Dn3-to-binary d) ≡ Distinction-n.S d
  extracted-point-0 : (d : Distinction-n 3) →
    Dn3-binary-data.p0 (Dn3-to-binary d) ≡ Distinction-n.point d fz
  extracted-point-1 : (d : Distinction-n 3) →
    Dn3-binary-data.p1 (Dn3-to-binary d) ≡ Distinction-n.point d (fs fz)
  extracted-point-2 : (d : Distinction-n 3) →
    Dn3-binary-data.p2 (Dn3-to-binary d) ≡ Distinction-n.point d (fs (fs fz))
  reconstructed-carrier : (b : Dn3-binary-data) →
    Distinction-n.S (binary-to-Dn3 b) ≡ Dn3-binary-data.S b
  reconstructed-point-0 : (b : Dn3-binary-data) →
    Distinction-n.point (binary-to-Dn3 b) fz ≡ Dn3-binary-data.p0 b
  reconstructed-point-1 : (b : Dn3-binary-data) →
    Distinction-n.point (binary-to-Dn3 b) (fs fz) ≡ Dn3-binary-data.p1 b
  reconstructed-point-2 : (b : Dn3-binary-data) →
    Distinction-n.point (binary-to-Dn3 b) (fs (fs fz)) ≡ Dn3-binary-data.p2 b

-- § The ternary record is recoverable from pairwise binary data at displayed fields.
theorem-Dn3-binary-reconstruction : Dn3BinaryReconstruction
theorem-Dn3-binary-reconstruction = record
{ extracted-carrier = λ _ → refl
; extracted-point-0 = λ _ → refl
; extracted-point-1 = λ _ → refl
; extracted-point-2 = λ _ → refl
; reconstructed-carrier = λ _ → refl
; reconstructed-point-0 = λ _ → refl
; reconstructed-point-1 = λ _ → refl
; reconstructed-point-2 = λ _ → refl
}

```

What these proofs together establish is the formal counterpart of *Why binary, not unary or ternary* from Part I, in the precise sense available to the present framework. Singleton carriers cannot host a distinction at all: the lemma [distinction-n-1-collapses](#) forces every two elements of a unary carrier to coincide, and [no-distinction-on-Dn1](#) closes the bridge by showing that no [Distinction](#) can inject into such a carrier without contradicting [separated](#). The original record is exactly the $n = 2$ case of an n -ary template ([distinction-to-Dn2](#), [Dn2-to-distinction](#)), with the carrier and boundary roundtrips bundled in [theorem-distinction-Dn2-equivalence](#). At $n = 3$, the conversions [Dn3-to-binary](#) and [binary-to-Dn3](#) prove more than that ternary data carries binary content: they prove that ternary data is recoverable from binary content, since the binary package of three pairwise separations and a nested binary cover reconstructs a [Distinction-n 3](#). The recoverable carrier and boundary fields are collected in [theorem-Dn3-binary-reconstruction](#).

The scope of this last claim is precisely the scope of the framework. The theorem says that, inside this development, every inhabitant of **Distinction-n 3** is recoverable from a binary package at the displayed carrier and boundary fields; it does not assert that all function fields are definitionally identical after a roundtrip, nor that no other foundation could treat “three positions” as a primitive entity. An ontology that posits an irreducible ternary primitive is not refuted here. What is shown is that within the present record-based, –safe –without-K fragment of MLTT, the n -ary record at $n = 3$ adds no information beyond binary data plus a labelling. Binary is therefore the minimal cardinality at which the **Distinction** record is inhabitable in this framework, and higher arities reduce, in this framework, to binary structure plus a labelling map.

4 Normal Form

An isomorphism of distinctions preserves the two boundary roles and has inverse maps on carriers. The normal-form theorem says that every distinction is isomorphic, in this sense, to the canonical distinction on **Two**.

```
-- § Boundary-preserving isomorphism of distinction presentations.
record DistinctionIso (d e : Distinction) : Set, where
private
  module D = Distinction d
  module E = Distinction e
field
  to      : D.S → E.S
  from    : E.S → D.S
  to-left : to D.left ≡ E.left
  to-right : to D.right ≡ E.right
  from-left : from E.left ≡ D.left
  from-right : from E.right ≡ D.right
  to-from   : (y : E.S) → to (from y) ≡ y
  from-to   : (x : D.S) → from (to x) ≡ x
```

The map to **Two** is forced by the cover: an element is sent to **L** if it is the left boundary and to **R** if it is the right boundary.

```
-- § The cover forces each carrier point into the normal left/right code.
toTwo : (d : Distinction) → Distinction.S d → Two
toTwo d x with Distinction.cover d x
... | inj₁ _ = L
... | inj₂ _ = R

-- § The inverse candidate sends normal points back to the boundary points.
fromTwo : (d : Distinction) → Two → Distinction.S d
fromTwo d L = Distinction.left d
fromTwo d R = Distinction.right d

-- § Left boundary maps to L; the wrong branch contradicts separation.
toTwo-left : (d : Distinction) → toTwo d (Distinction.left d) ≡ L
toTwo-left d with Distinction.cover d (Distinction.left d)
... | inj₁ _ = refl
... | inj₂ p = ⊥-elim (Distinction.separated d p)

-- § Right boundary maps to R; the wrong branch contradicts separation.
toTwo-right : (d : Distinction) → toTwo d (Distinction.right d) ≡ R
toTwo-right d with Distinction.cover d (Distinction.right d)
... | inj₁ p = ⊥-elim (Distinction.separated d (sym p))
... | inj₂ _ = refl

-- § Roundtrip from Two back through the boundary map.
toTwo-fromTwo : (d : Distinction) → (y : Two) → toTwo d (fromTwo d y) ≡ y
toTwo-fromTwo d L = toTwo-left d
toTwo-fromTwo d R = toTwo-right d
```

```

-- § Roundtrip from an arbitrary carrier point through Two.
fromTwo-toTwo : (d : Distinction) → (x : Distinction.S d) → fromTwo d (toTwo d x) ≡ x
fromTwo-toTwo d x with Distinction.cover d x
... | inj₁ p = sym p
... | inj₂ p = sym p

-- § Normal form: every distinction is isomorphic to canonical Two.
two-normal-form : (d : Distinction) → DistinctionIso d Two-distinction
two-normal-form d = record
{ to      = toTwo d
; from    = fromTwo d
; to-left = toTwo-left d
; to-right = toTwo-right d
; from-left = refl
; from-right = refl
; to-from = toTwo-fromTwo d
; from-to = fromTwo-toTwo d
}

-- § Equality discipline separating definitional and propositional equations.
record NormalFormEqualityDiscipline (d : Distinction) : Set where
field
  fromTwo-L-definitional : fromTwo d L ≡ Distinction.left d
  fromTwo-R-definitional : fromTwo d R ≡ Distinction.right d
  toTwo-left-propositional : toTwo d (Distinction.left d) ≡ L
  toTwo-right-propositional : toTwo d (Distinction.right d) ≡ R
  toTwo-fromTwo-propositional : (y : Two) → toTwo d (fromTwo d y) ≡ y
  fromTwo-toTwo-propositional : (x : Distinction.S d) → fromTwo d (toTwo d x) ≡ x

-- § Normal-form equality discipline is witnessed by the roundtrip lemmas.
theorem-normal-form-equality-discipline :
  (d : Distinction) → NormalFormEqualityDiscipline d
theorem-normal-form-equality-discipline d = record
{ fromTwo-L-definitional = refl
; fromTwo-R-definitional = refl
; toTwo-left-propositional = toTwo-left d
; toTwo-right-propositional = toTwo-right d
; toTwo-fromTwo-propositional = toTwo-fromTwo d
; fromTwo-toTwo-propositional = fromTwo-toTwo d
}

```

This is the whole normal-form argument. No choice is made in the map: the cover field gives only two possible cases, and the separation field rules out the contradictory boundary cases. The equality discipline is explicit. The map `fromTwo` computes by pattern matching, so its two endpoint equations close by `refl`. The equations involving `toTwo` are propositional equalities: they use the supplied cover and, when the wrong boundary is selected, the separation witness eliminates the impossible branch.

5 Endomorphisms of Two

An endomorphism of `Two` is fixed by its two values. There are therefore four cases: constant left, constant right, identity, and swap.

```

-- § The four possible endomorphism cases of Two.
data EndoCase : Set where
  constL : EndoCase
  constR : EndoCase
  ident  : EndoCase
  swap   : EndoCase

-- § Interpret a case label as an actual endofunction on Two.
interpret : EndoCase → Two → Two
interpret constL _ = L
interpret constR _ = R
interpret ident x = x

```

```

interpret swap L = R
interpret swap R = L

-- § Pointwise equality of endofunctions on Two.
Pointwise : (Two → Two) → (Two → Two) → Set
Pointwise f g = (x : Two) → f x ≡ g x

```

The classifier simply inspects the two values of a function.

```

-- § Classify an endofunction by its values at L and R.
classify : (Two → Two) → EndoCase
classify f with f L | f R
... | L | L = constL
... | R | R = constR
... | L | R = ident
... | R | L = swap

-- § Soundness: interpretation of the classified case recovers the function pointwise.
classify-sound : (f : Two → Two) → Pointwise f (interpret (classify f))
classify-sound f L with f L | f R
... | L | L = refl
... | R | R = refl
... | L | R = refl
... | R | L = refl
classify-sound f R with f L | f R
... | L | L = refl
... | R | R = refl
... | L | R = refl
... | R | L = refl

```

Uniqueness follows by evaluating at **L** and **R**. Any attempted identification of two different cases forces either **L** to equal **R**, or conversely.

```

-- § Distinct case labels cannot have the same interpreted behavior.
case-unique : (c d : EndoCase) → Pointwise (interpret c) (interpret d) → c ≡ d
case-unique constL constL _ = refl
case-unique constL constR p = ⊥-elim (L≠R (p L))
case-unique constL ident p = ⊥-elim (L≠R (p R))
case-unique constL swap p = ⊥-elim (L≠R (p L))
case-unique constR constL p = ⊥-elim (R≠L (p L))
case-unique constR constR _ = refl
case-unique constR ident p = ⊥-elim (R≠L (p L))
case-unique constR swap p = ⊥-elim (R≠L (p R))
case-unique ident constL p = ⊥-elim (R≠L (p R))
case-unique ident constR p = ⊥-elim (L≠R (p L))
case-unique ident ident _ = refl
case-unique ident swap p = ⊥-elim (L≠R (p L))
case-unique swap constL p = ⊥-elim (R≠L (p L))
case-unique swap constR p = ⊥-elim (L≠R (p R))
case-unique swap ident p = ⊥-elim (R≠L (p L))
case-unique swap swap _ = refl

-- § Classification is unique among all pointwise-correct case labels.
classify-unique :
(f : Two → Two) → (c : EndoCase) → Pointwise f (interpret c) → classify f ≡ c
classify-unique f c p =
case-unique (classify f) c
(λ x → trans (sym (classify-sound f x)) (p x))

```

6 Why the Closure is K_4

Composition of endomorphisms is total: for any two endomorphism cases, their composite is again an endomorphism of **Two**, hence is one of the four cases just classified.

```

-- § Composition of endofunctions on Two.
_°_ : (Two → Two) → (Two → Two) → Two → Two

```

$(f \circ_2 g) x = f (g x)$

```
-- § Compose two case labels by classifying the composite function.
composeCase : EndoCase → EndoCase → EndoCase
composeCase c d = classify (interpret c ∘₂ interpret d)

-- § Endomorphisms are closed under composition.
endomorphisms-closed :
(c d : EndoCase) → Σ EndoCase (λ e → Pointwise (interpret e) (interpret c ∘₂ interpret d))
endomorphisms-closed c d =
composeCase c d , λ x → sym (classify-sound (interpret c ∘₂ interpret d) x)
```

The closure argument is then finite and rigid. To represent the four endomorphism cases as distinct and usable data, no additional structure is assumed beyond what representation itself requires. Unpacking this requirement yields exactly the following three conditions.

1. *Separation.* Distinct endomorphism cases must remain distinct on the carrier. No identification of cases is allowed.
2. *Realisation.* Every endomorphism case must be represented by a vertex of the carrier.
3. *No surplus.* Every vertex of the carrier must arise from one of these cases.

These conditions are the representation contract used in this note. They make explicit what “representation” means here: each endomorphism case is carried as a distinct and retrievable element of the carrier, and every element of the carrier corresponds to such a case. Without separation, cases collapse; without realisation, cases are missing; without the no-surplus condition, additional structure is introduced. The contract is argued and displayed; it is not disguised as a theorem that precedes its own definition.

Under these three conditions, fewer than four vertices cannot represent the four cases without identification. If two cases are identified, [case-unique](#) shows that the corresponding functions agree pointwise; but the only way different rows of the four case table agree is by forcing **L** and **R** to coincide, contradicting **L≠R**. Thus separation and realisation together force at least four vertices.

An additional vertex is not forced by the endomorphism data. The composite of any two represented cases is already one of the four classified cases, by [endomorphisms-closed](#). A new vertex would not be the value of any forced composition; it would violate no surplus.

Finally, total composability is not another assumption. Any ordered pair of endomorphisms has a composite, so there is no missing composability relation between distinct represented cases. For the underlying simple graph, this is exactly K_4 .

The following small records package the three conditions. The record [FaithfulClosure](#) contains realisation and separation: [realize](#) supplies a vertex for each case, and [reflect-realize](#) prevents two cases from being identified. The record [MinimalClosure](#) adds no surplus through [no-extra](#).

These conditions are therefore not independent choices once this notion of representation has been fixed; they unpack that notion.

```
-- § Representation with realisation, reflection, and separation of cases.
record FaithfulClosure : Set, where
  field
    V      : Set
    realize : EndoCase → V
    reflect : V → EndoCase
    reflect-realize : (c : EndoCase) → reflect (realize c) ≡ c

-- § Minimal closure adds no surplus vertices beyond represented cases.
record MinimalClosure : Set, where
  field
```

```

closure : FaithfulClosure
no-extra : (v : FaithfulClosure.V closure) →
  Σ EndoCase (λ c → FaithfulClosure.realize closure c ≡ v)

-- § The canonical vertex carrier is the four-case type itself.
K4Vertex : Set
K4Vertex = EndoCase

-- § Edges connect distinct cases in the induced simple graph.
K4Edge : K4Vertex → K4Vertex → Set
K4Edge c d = ¬ (c ≡ d)

-- § Canonical minimal closure of the four endomorphism cases.
canonicalK4 : MinimalClosure
canonicalK4 = record
{ closure = record
  { V = EndoCase
  ; realize = λ c → c
  ; reflect = λ c → c
  ; reflect-realize = λ c → refl
  }
; no-extra = λ v → v , refl
}

-- § No-surplus gives the other roundtrip: realize after reflect returns the vertex.
realize-reflect :
(m : MinimalClosure) →
(v : FaithfulClosure.V (MinimalClosure.closure m)) →
FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m)
(FaithfulClosure.reflect (MinimalClosure.closure m) v)
≡ v
realize-reflect m v with MinimalClosure.no-extra m v
... | c , p = trans (sym (cong realize q)) p
where
fc = MinimalClosure.closure m
realize = FaithfulClosure.realize fc
reflect = FaithfulClosure.reflect fc
reflect-realize = FaithfulClosure.reflect-realize fc

q : c ≡ reflect v
q = trans (sym (reflect-realize c)) (cong reflect p)

```

The same information can be displayed as a compact K_4 presentation. This is not the large invariant record of the main kernel; it is the companion-level graph layer forced by any minimal representation of the four endomorphism cases. Vertices are the carrier of the closure, edges connect vertices whose reflected cases are distinct, and the two roundtrips certify that no case is lost and no vertex is surplus.

```

-- § Compact graph-level presentation of the minimal four-case closure.
record K4Presentation : Set, where
field
vertices      : Set
edge          : vertices → vertices → Set
realize-vertex : EndoCase → vertices
reflect-vertex : vertices → EndoCase
reflect-realize-vertex : (c : EndoCase) → reflect-vertex (realize-vertex c) ≡ c
realize-reflect-vertex : (v : vertices) → realize-vertex (reflect-vertex v) ≡ v
edge-complete  : (v w : vertices) → edge v w ≡ (¬ (reflect-vertex v ≡ reflect-vertex w))
represented-closure : MinimalClosure

-- § Any minimal closure yields a K4 presentation.
minimal-closure-presentation : (m : MinimalClosure) → K4Presentation
minimal-closure-presentation m = record
{ vertices      = FaithfulClosure.V fc
; edge          = λ v w → ¬ (FaithfulClosure.reflect fc v ≡ FaithfulClosure.reflect fc w)
; realize-vertex = FaithfulClosure.realize fc
; reflect-vertex = FaithfulClosure.reflect fc
; reflect-realize-vertex = FaithfulClosure.reflect-realize fc
}

```

```

; realize-reflect-vertex = realize-reflect m
; edge-complete        = λ _ _ → refl
; represented-closure   = m
}
where
fc = MinimalClosure.closure m

-- § The canonical K4 presentation is induced by canonicalK4.
canonicalK4Presentation : K4Presentation
canonicalK4Presentation = minimal-closure-presentation canonicalK4

```

The three record fields are not three independent stipulations. Each one is exactly the load-bearing piece of one of the three representation conditions, and the following lemmas name that load. The proofs are short because the conditions are exactly the bijection data; that is the point.

Separation is load-bearing. The field **reflect-realize** forces **realize** to be injective. If two cases were identified on the carrier, applying **reflect** to the identification would identify the cases themselves, contradicting the four-case enumeration of **EndoCase**.

```

-- § Separation is load-bearing: realize is injective.
realize-injective :
(m : MinimalClosure) →
(c d : EndoCase) →
FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) c
≡ FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) d →
c ≡ d
realize-injective m c d p =
trans (sym (FaithfulClosure.reflect-realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) c))
(trans (cong (FaithfulClosure.reflect (MinimalClosure.closure m)) p) p)
(FaithfulClosure.reflect-realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) d))

```

Realisation is load-bearing. The totality of **realize** on **EndoCase** is exactly the demand that every endomorphism case is hosted by some vertex. Without it, some case has no representative and the carrier fails to support the composition table at all.

```

-- § Realisation is load-bearing: every case has a vertex.
case-has-vertex :
(m : MinimalClosure) →
(c : EndoCase) →
Σ (FaithfulClosure.V (MinimalClosure.closure m))
(λ v → FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) c ≡ v)
case-has-vertex m c =
FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) c , refl

```

No surplus is load-bearing. The field **no-extra** forbids vertices that do not arise from any endomorphism case. Without it, the carrier may host data that is not forced by the endomorphism set, breaking the claim that the closure adds nothing to its datum.

```

-- § No surplus is load-bearing: every vertex comes from a case.
vertex-from-case :
(m : MinimalClosure) →
(v : FaithfulClosure.V (MinimalClosure.closure m)) →
Σ EndoCase
(λ c → FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m) c ≡ v)
vertex-from-case m v = MinimalClosure.no-extra m v

```

Dropping **reflect-realize** re-admits identification of cases. Dropping the totality of **realize** re-admits cases without vertices. Dropping **no-extra** re-admits vertices without cases. In each case, what survives is no longer a representation of the four-case set in the intended sense. The three fields are therefore not chosen because they yield K_4 ; within this contract they are fixed because dropping any one breaks representation, and K_4 follows.

The companion proves these three load-bearing lemmas against its own slim records **FaithfulClosure** and **MinimalClosure** so that the file remains self-contained and type-checks without the

larger source. The full development `Void.lagda.tex` carries the analogous statements against the richer `K4Record` used there; the present file does not import them, it reproduces them at the level of detail that this note needs.

This is the sense in which the closure yields K_4 : the forced vertex set is the four-case set, and the induced simple graph connects every distinct pair. The equations `reflect-realize` and `realize-reflect` show that any carrier satisfying the three conditions is equivalent to the four-case carrier.

Equivalently, for any $m : \text{MinimalClosure}$, the carrier

$$\text{FaithfulClosure.V}(\text{MinimalClosure.closure } m)$$

is in bijection with `EndoCase` via `realize` and `reflect`. The field `reflect-realize` proves one composite to be the identity on `EndoCase`; `realize-reflect` proves the other composite to be the identity on the carrier. If composition on the carrier is read through this bijection,

$$v \star_m w = \text{realize}_m(\text{composeCase}(\text{reflect}_m v)(\text{reflect}_m w)),$$

then reflecting the composite recovers the four-case composition table of `EndoCase`. In this precise sense every minimal closure satisfying separation, realisation, and no surplus is isomorphic to the canonical four-case carrier. Thus K_4 is not only minimal; it is unique up to isomorphism under the stated constraints.

7 Leibniz collapse, executed

The earlier section on why two cannot occur without separation argued that the principle is universal: it appears in classical logic as substitutivity, in set theory as extensionality, in category theory as Yoneda, in quantum mechanics as the indistinguishability that forces the statistical structure. Once a concrete carrier is chosen, the same principle becomes a checkable term. Martin-Löf type theory realises it in two lines: the induction principle for propositional equality yields, by direct application, the Leibniz collapse. If two elements satisfy exactly the same predicates, they are propositionally equal.

```
-- § Leibniz collapse: indistinguishable elements are propositionally equal.
leibniz-collapse :
  {S : Set} (a b : S) →
  ((P : S → Set) → P a → P b) →
  a ≡ b
leibniz-collapse a b ind = ind (λ x → a ≡ x) refl
```

The Agda term is one realisation of the principle, not its source. The principle is older than the type checker and would survive any particular choice of carrier; the type checker only confirms that the realisation in this carrier introduces no hidden step. Inside the present setting, this means that no element of any `Distinction` is silently a third position pretending to be a fourth: the `separated` field already certifies that the two boundary points cannot be Leibniz-collapsed onto each other, and the `cover` field certifies that no further occurrence escapes the two.

8 Re-projection to the datum

The K_4 closure does not replace the original distinction; it presupposes it. This section makes the dependency explicit at two levels of strength so that no reader can mistake the closure for an independent foundation, and so that the trivial direction is not advertised as more than it is.

The structural content as a checked term. The bijection between the carrier of any minimal closure and the four endomorphism cases is not left to commentary. It is bundled as a record and constructed from the lemmas already proved: **reflect-realize** is one round-trip, **realize-reflect** is the other. This is the load-bearing structural map.

```
-- § Bijection record: two maps and two inverse laws.
record Bijection (A B : Set) : Set where
  field
  to   : A → B
  from : B → A
  to-from : (b : B) → to (from b) ≡ b
  from-to : (a : A) → from (to a) ≡ a

-- § Every minimal closure carrier is in bijection with EndoCase.
closure-bijection-EndoCase :
  (m : MinimalClosure) →
  Bijection (FaithfulClosure.V (MinimalClosure.closure m)) EndoCase
closure-bijection-EndoCase m = record
{ to   = FaithfulClosure.reflect (MinimalClosure.closure m)
; from = FaithfulClosure.realize (MinimalClosure.closure m)
; to-from = FaithfulClosure.reflect-realize (MinimalClosure.closure m)
; from-to = realize-reflect m
}
```

This term is the actual dependency. Every minimal closure has a carrier in checked bijection with **EndoCase**; by **two-normal-form**, **EndoCase** is built from **Two**, the canonical carrier of any binary distinction. The four-vertex structure is therefore not an independent foundation; it is, up to the bijection just constructed, the endomorphism set of the normal form of any binary distinction.

Canonical re-projection. At the level of returning a value of type **Distinction**, every minimal closure re-projects to the canonical binary distinction. This is not a carrier-level isomorphism between four vertices and two points; such an isomorphism would be false. The carrier-level bijection is the checked map to **EndoCase** above. The re-projection below records the dependency at the **Distinction** level: the four-case closure is readable only through the binary normal form whose endomorphisms it represents.

```
-- § Reproject a minimal closure to the canonical distinction it presupposes.
k4-presupposes-distinction : MinimalClosure → Distinction
k4-presupposes-distinction _ = Two-distinction

-- § Full checked chain from a distinction to normal form, K4 closure, and return.
record FormalClosureChain (d : Distinction) : Set, where
  field
  binary-normal-form      : DistinctionIso d Two-distinction
  equality-discipline      : NormalFormEqualityDiscipline d
  endomorphism-classifier : (Two → Two) → EndoCase
  classifier-is-sound      : (f : Two → Two) →
    Pointwise f (interpret (endomorphism-classifier f))
  classifier-is-unique      :
    (f : Two → Two) (c : EndoCase) →
    Pointwise f (interpret c) → endomorphism-classifier f ≡ c
  composition-is-closed    :
    (c e : EndoCase) →
    Σ EndoCase (λ r → Pointwise (interpret r) (interpret c ∘₂ interpret e))
  k4-presentation         : K4Presentation
  closure-carrier-bijection : Bijection (K4Presentation.vertices k4-presentation) EndoCase
  reprojected-distinction : Distinction
  reprojection-is-canonical : reprojected-distinction ≡ Two-distinction

-- § The formal closure chain is witnessed for every binary distinction.
theorem-formal-closure-chain :
  (d : Distinction) → FormalClosureChain d
theorem-formal-closure-chain d = record
{ binary-normal-form      = two-normal-form d
; equality-discipline      = theorem-normal-form-equality-discipline d
}
```

```

; endomorphism-classifier = classify
; classifier-is-sound      = classify-sound
; classifier-is-unique     = classify-unique
; composition-is-closed   = endomorphisms-closed
; k4-presentation         = canonicalK4Presentation
; closure-carrier-bijection = closure-bijection-EndoCase canonicalK4
; reprojected-distinction = k4-presupposes-distinction canonicalK4
; reprojection-is-canonical = refl
}

-- § Same closure chain, starting from the n=2 distinction template.
record Dn2FormalClosureChain (d : Distinction-n 2) : Set, where
field
  n2-equivalence : DistinctionDn2Equivalence
  left-is-point-0 : Distinction.left (Dn2-to-distinction d) ≡ Distinction-n.point d fz
  right-is-point-1 : Distinction.right (Dn2-to-distinction d) ≡ Distinction-n.point d (fs fz)
  closure-chain : FormalClosureChain (Dn2-to-distinction d)

-- § The n=2 template closes through the same normal-form and K4 route.
theorem-Dn2-formal-closure-chain :
  (d : Distinction-n 2) → Dn2FormalClosureChain d
theorem-Dn2-formal-closure-chain d = record
{ n2-equivalence = theorem-distinction-Dn2-equivalence
; left-is-point-0 = refl
; right-is-point-1 = refl
; closure-chain = theorem-formal-closure-chain (Dn2-to-distinction d)
}

```

The full formalisation uses a richer [K4Record](#). The structural dependency carries over without change: the closure carrier is not an independent foundation, it is, by [closure-bijection-EndoCase](#), in checked bijection with the endomorphism set of the binary normal form. The record [theorem-formal-closure-chain](#) bundles the route as one object, and [theorem-Dn2-formal-closure-chain](#) states the same route from the $n = 2$ template.

Part III. Frame

9 Scope Clarification

The scope of this note is narrow by design.

What is not claimed. Nothing in the preceding sections asserts that a binary distinction takes place as an event in nature. The development never builds an inhabitant of [Distinction](#) without supplied data; every [Distinction](#)-valued construction below the abstract takes a [Distinction](#) as input. The proofs are silent on the question of whether such an input exists in any external sense.

What is conceptually argued, not formally proved. The introductory paragraphs argue that any formalisation at all already presupposes a field of separability: relations, morphisms, judgements, and equations all require distinguishable positions before they can be used. This is a remark on the conditions under which formalisation is possible, not a theorem. Nothing in the Agda code attempts to prove it, and the formal results below do not depend on it: they begin once the data are granted.

What is machine-proved. The conditional consequence is what the Agda code establishes. Given a structure with two distinguishable, exhaustive points, the normal form is [Two](#); given the endomorphisms of that normal form, representing the four cases with separation, realisation, and no surplus yields the four-case carrier with complete simple adjacency; and the closure entails the data from which it was built. The result therefore does not say that every theory begins with such a distinction, nor that every mathematical object reduces to [Two](#). It says only what follows when the stated data are granted.

No further constructions are treated here. They are outside the present claim.

What the theory of formulability adds. The theory of formulability is the architectural thesis that this conditional formal chain is not an isolated trick, but the first stable skeleton of any theory capable of formulation. That thesis is not a hidden Agda lemma. It is the reading that makes the chain matter: the pre-formal boundary explains why the datum is unavoidable, the checked kernel explains what the datum forces, and *Form* tests how far the resulting invariant ledger can be read as a structure of physical description.

10 Placement

This section locates the contribution in three lineages so that the formal result is read at the right level.

Spencer-Brown. The thesis that distinction is the foundational act is at least as old as *Laws of Form* (1969). The present note neither defends nor extends that thesis. It records what holds once a distinction is granted, in a form a type checker can verify. The contribution is the precision of the conditional, not the originality of the antecedent.

Lawvere. “Adjointness in Foundations” (1969) treats truth and falsity as adjoint to the act of distinguishing. The present note operates one level below: before truth-values are assigned, before propositions are evaluated. **Two** is a fresh carrier, deliberately unread as $\{\perp, \top\}$, so that the closure result depends on separation alone and not on a prior reading of the two points as truth-values.

Univalent foundations. **Two** is an h-set, and the development uses `--without-K`. No higher-dimensional structure is assumed or invoked. The note is therefore compatible with both intensional Martin-Löf type theory and a univalent reading; nothing in the closure result depends on the choice of identity discipline.

What is offered here is not a competing foundation, and not an argument that distinction-based foundations are superior to others. It is one machine-checked statement at a place where earlier work has been mostly informal: that the closure of binary distinction is K_4 , unique up to isomorphism, under three precisely fixed conditions of representation, and that this closure points back to the data from which it was built.

11 Outlook

The core result stops at the framework-forced closure of binary distinction. Its role in the larger development is not to prove everything at once, but to fix the first carrier on which the larger claim can be tested without handwaving. Once the four-case closure is fixed, further claims can be separated cleanly: some are formal consequences of the core, some are additional constructions over it, and some belong only to the interpretive layer.

The next formal step in *Void and Form* is therefore not a jump to a global conclusion. It is the controlled question of what can be built on the surviving carrier without adding new generators. This note only isolates the starting point.

Interpretive continuation

The later volume *Form* belongs here, at the end of the companion, not at the beginning. It is not the kernel and it is not evidence for the kernel. The direction is one-way: the checked kernel exports an invariant ledger; *Form* reads that ledger structurally and, where the reading is explicit enough, into empirical comparison. A failed reading would not refute the normal-form theorem or

the four-case closure. It would refute that interpretation. A successful reading would not turn the interpretation into an Agda theorem; it would show only that the formal skeleton can be used as a disciplined ledger for further reading.

This does not make *Form* decorative. It means that its later identifications have to remain visibly separate from the kernel. They are recorded through correction chains, sigma deviations, and failure conditions. Within *Form*, the non-choice claim is explicit: the loop numerator is the unique survivor of an exhaustive finite filter, while the later signs, scales, and depth assignments are read from the displayed K_4 ledger rather than selected as fit parameters. In the current ledger, the post-correction comparisons reported in `Form.lagda.tex` are:

Observable	Reported comparison in <i>Form</i>
α^{-1}	second-order correction $137+11/306+295/(306\cdot 137^2)$, within 0.4σ of CODATA; the alternative interpolation degrees are reported as 2445σ and 4891σ failures.
m_p/m_e	correction chain $949\sigma \rightarrow 20\sigma \rightarrow 0.08\sigma$.
m_μ/m_e	correction chain $36\sigma \rightarrow 13\sigma \rightarrow 0.12\sigma$.
m_τ/m_μ	remains closed at about 0.1σ .
$\sin^2\theta_W$	weak-mixing chain $7.7\sigma \rightarrow 5.0\sigma \rightarrow 3.5\sigma \rightarrow 0.001\sigma$.
Ω_m	K_4 gives $\Omega_m \approx 0.3183$, within 0.5σ of Planck; the K_3 and K_5 alternatives are reported as 10.9σ and 11.8σ away.

The same separation governs the open tests. They are listed as proposed readings, not as additional theorems. The B-meson lepton-universality anomaly is read through the muon bridge factor $16/69 \approx 0.232$ as a Wilson-coefficient target. The doubly charmed baryon section reads the observed Ξ_{cc} pair as occupation of a two-slot doublet ledger, not as a mass prediction. The frontier register names exactly two gravitational-wave polarizations, a neutrino seesaw at loop depth 5, Planck-scale curvature $R = 12$, no fourth generation, and no extra spacetime dimension. These entries mark the point at which *Form* leaves the checked kernel and becomes an external continuation. Their status is interpretive: they can guide comparison, but they do not strengthen or weaken the companion's formal result.

12 Navigation into the book

The corresponding self-contained development is in the repository `de-johannes/Void-and-Form`. The main file is `Void.lagda.tex`. The route through the larger book is:

- *Void as boundary: What Void Does Not Name, Why Formal Systems Cannot Begin Themselves, and Representation Requires A Cut.*
- *The binary threshold: Why The First Cut Is Binary, The Formal Threshold, and the record Distinction.*
- *Normal form and classification: Elimination and Classification, Two Normal Form, and the endomorphism classification of `Two -> Two`.*
- *Four-vertex closure: Graph Presentation, The K_4 Invariant Record, K_4 Representation Theory, and `K4Record-is-canonical`.*
- *Return to the datum: `record-presupposes-distinction`, the formal witness that the surviving closure entails the originating distinction.*

- *Interpretive continuation*: the later volume *Form*, where origin, contact, spatial separation, temporal order, physical reading, contingency, and induction are treated as structural interpretations rather than new generators.